

Topic 7: AI Image Generation Tools

7.1 Midjourney

- Midjourney produces the highest aesthetic quality among current AI image tools -- popular with designers and artists
- Access: via the Midjourney website (midjourney.com) or its Discord server
- Pricing: Basic \$10/month (~200 images); Standard \$30/month (unlimited relaxed generation); Pro \$60/month
- No free tier currently; best for professional creative work where quality matters
- Prompt structure: [subject] [style] [lighting] [colour palette] [mood] [aspect ratio parameter]

WEAK: a cat outside

STRONG:

A fluffy orange tabby cat on ancient stone steps,
purple wisteria overhead, soft golden-hour light,
shallow depth of field, 85mm lens, photorealistic --ar 4:5 --v 6

Key parameters:

--ar 16:9 (landscape) --ar 9:16 (portrait) --ar 1:1 (square)
--v 6 (latest model) --style raw (less opinionated output)
--no text (exclude text from the image)

7.2 DALL-E 3 (OpenAI)

- DALL-E 3 is integrated into ChatGPT Plus and available via the OpenAI API
- Strengths: excellent prompt adherence, reliably renders legible text within images, strong commercial licensing terms
- How to use: in ChatGPT Plus, simply describe the image you want in natural language
- ChatGPT optionally improves your prompt before sending to DALL-E -- you can view and edit the revised prompt
- Best for: illustrations, diagrams, marketing materials, mockups, and any image that needs specific text
- API access: platform.openai.com/docs/guides/images

7.3 Stable Diffusion (Open Source)

- Stable Diffusion is an open-source model you can download and run locally at no cost
- Interfaces: Automatic1111, ComfyUI (node-based workflow), or Fooocus (simplified UI for beginners)

- Hardware: NVIDIA GPU with 6GB+ VRAM for good speed; also runs on CPU and Apple Silicon (slower)
- LoRA adapters: fine-tuned add-ons that change the model's style, add a character, or adjust quality
- ControlNet: use pose skeletons, depth maps, or edge maps to control image composition precisely
- Community resources: <https://civitai.com> for models, LoRAs, and prompt guides

7.4 Other Notable Image Tools

- Adobe Firefly (firefly.adobe.com): trained exclusively on licensed Adobe Stock -- safest for commercial use
 - Ideogram (ideogram.ai): especially strong at rendering legible text inside images; free tier available
 - Flux (Black Forest Labs): high-quality open-weight model available via Hugging Face and Replicate
 - Leonardo.ai: good free tier; offers fine-tuning and a model library; popular for game asset creation
 - Canva AI: image generation and editing built into Canva's design tool -- best for non-designers already using Canva
 - Choosing: use DALL-E 3 for speed and text-in-image; Midjourney for artistic quality; Stable Diffusion for customisation and cost
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